

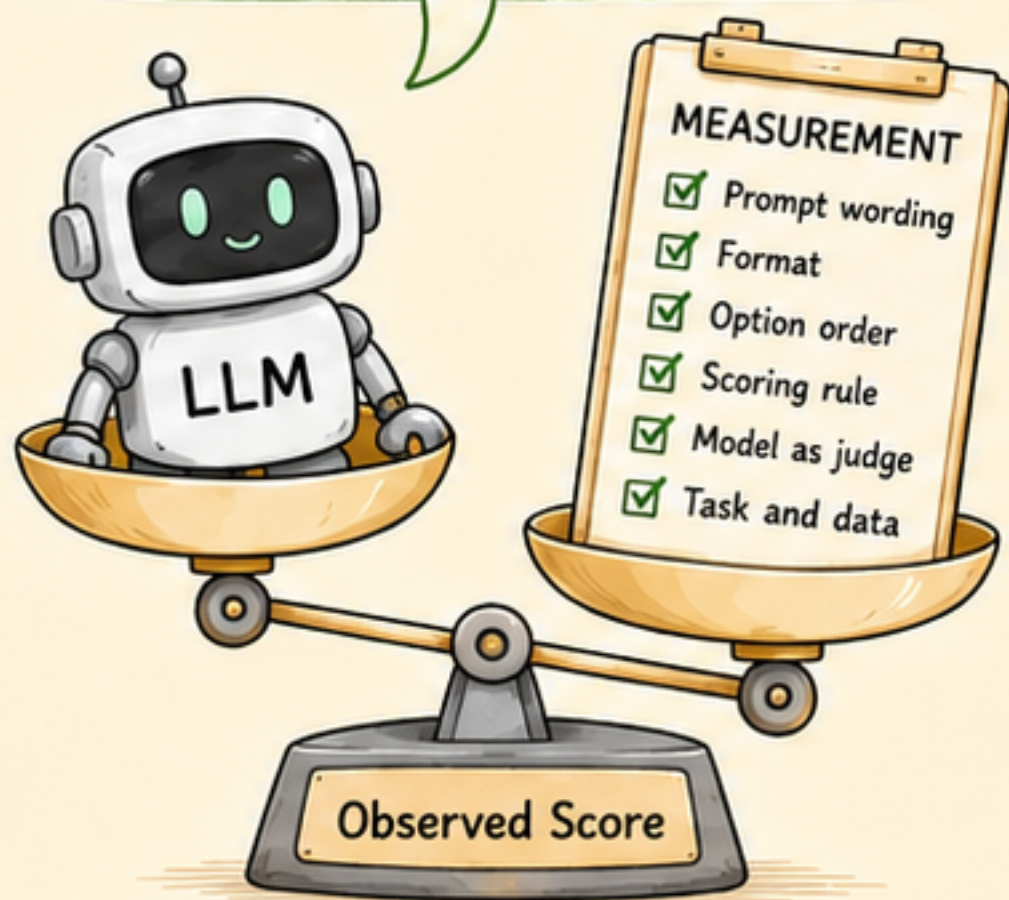
Measurement is not a Trait

The same language model can appear different when harmless details of evaluation change.

A measured score should not automatically be treated as a stable behavioural trait.

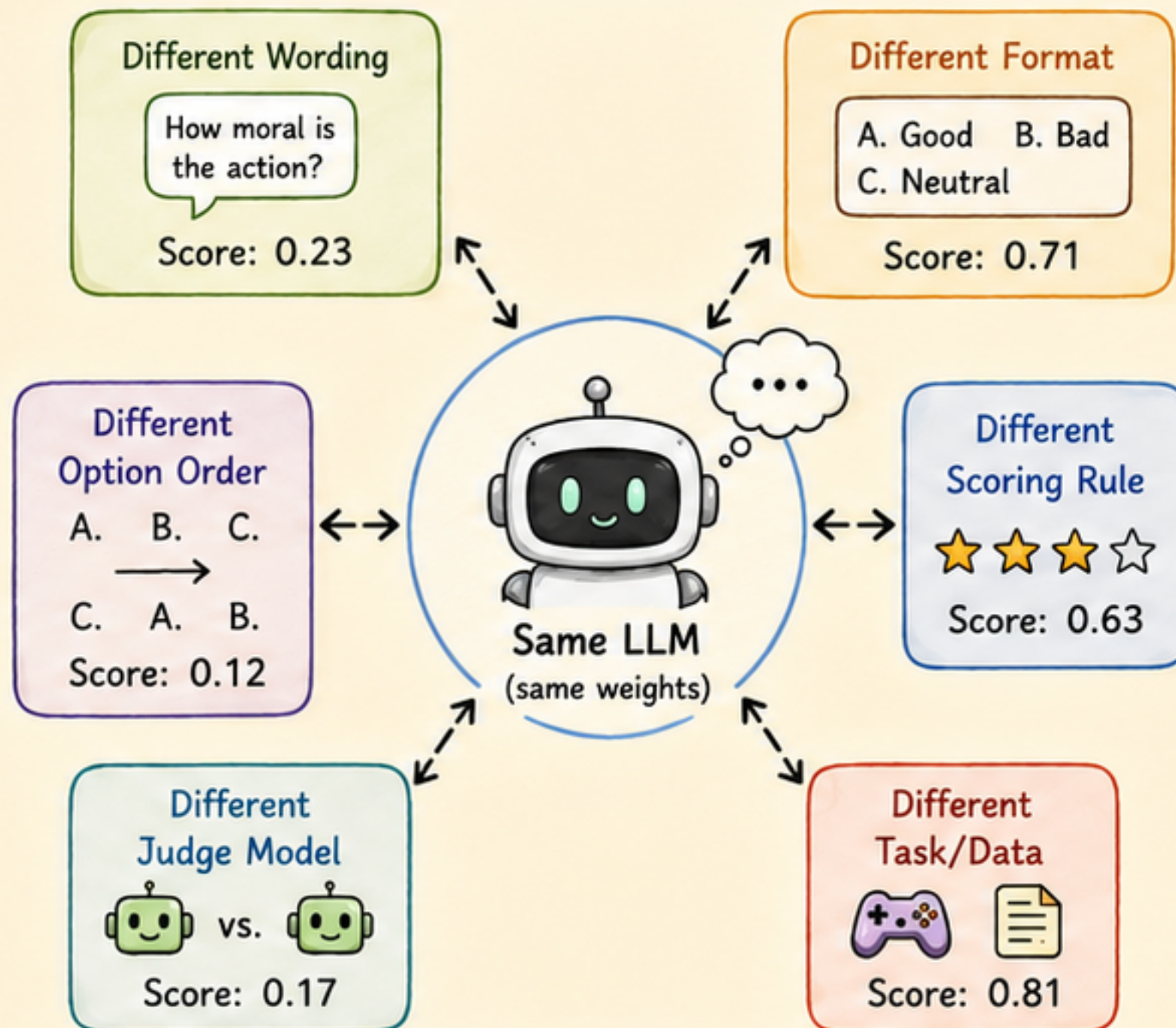
THE IDEA

We observe outputs and obtain a score.
This is **not** the model's trait;
it is the result of a measurement.



When the measurement changes, the **score** can change, and so can the **story**.

SAME MODEL, DIFFERENT MEASUREMENTS



Harmless changes, large differences.
The **measurement** is moving,
not necessarily the model.

DON'T DO THIS



✗ One score is not a stable trait.
It may reflect a measurement artifact.

DO THIS INSTEAD

- ✓ Probe variation to assess reliability
- ✓ Test the construct and scoring for validity
- ✓ Check transfer to assess generalizability
- ✓ Report scope and uncertainty



Only then should we state a claim,
together with its scope.

Takeaway: Scores describe measurements. Traits require evidence.

Measure

→ Audit

→ Claim (with scope)

The story we tell must survive
the measurement we change.

